

within forty-eight hours, may themselves carry out the work and recover from him summarily as a civil debt the expenses reasonably incurred by them in so doing but without prejudice to the rights and obligations, as between themselves, of the owner and the occupier of the premises.

Table of Statutes referred to in this Act

Short Title	Session and Chapter
Telegraph Act, 1878	41 & 42 Vict. c. 76.
Road Traffic Act, 1930	20 & 21 Geo. 5. c. 43.
Local Government Act, 1933	23 & 24 Geo. 5. c. 51.
Public Health Act, 1936	26 Geo. 5 & 1 Edw. 8. c. 49.
Housing Act, 1936	26 Geo. 5 & 1 Edw. 8. c. 51.
London Government Act, 1939	2 & 3 Geo. 6. c. 40.
Water Act, 1945	8 & 9 Geo. 6. c. 42.
Local Government (Scotland) Act, 1947	10 & 11 Geo. 6. c. 43.
Local Government Act, 1948	11 & 12 Geo. 6. c. 26.
Housing Act, 1949	12, 13 & 14 Geo. 6. c. 60.
New Streets Act, 1951	14 & 15 Geo. 6. c. 40.
Nottinghamshire County Council Act, 1951	14 & 15 Geo. 6. c. xlv.
Glamorgan County Council Act, 1952	15 & 16 Geo. 6 & 1 Eliz. 2. c. li.

CHAPTER 27

An Act to provide for the humane slaughter of pigs in places other than slaughterhouses and knackers' yards ; and for purposes connected therewith.

[14th July 1953.]

BE it enacted by the Queen's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:—

1. No pig exceeding twelve weeks in age shall be slaughtered in any place other than a slaughterhouse or knacker's yard unless—

- (a) it shall be instantaneously slaughtered or shall by stunning be instantaneously rendered insensible to pain until death supervenes; and
- (b) the slaughter or stunning shall be effected by means of a mechanically-operated instrument in proper repair:

Provided that this section shall not apply if the pig is slaughtered at any laboratory, research station or similar institution, for the purposes of the diagnosis of disease or research in connection with the arts of veterinary surgery or medicine.

Slaughter
of pigs
otherwise
than in
slaughter-
house or
knacker's
yard.

2. If any person intentionally slaughters or stuns, or attempts to slaughter or stun, a pig in contravention of the provisions of this Act, he shall be liable on summary conviction to a fine not exceeding ten pounds, or on a second conviction to a fine not exceeding twenty pounds, or on any subsequent conviction to imprisonment for a period not exceeding three months or to a fine not exceeding twenty pounds, or to both such imprisonment and fine:

Provided that it shall be a defence for any person to prove that he acted bona fide in any emergency or for the purpose of preventing or arresting injury or suffering or the spread of disease to any person or animal and that he took all reasonable steps in the circumstances to prevent the infliction of unnecessary suffering.

3.—(1) In this Act—

“mechanically-operated instrument” has in England the same meaning as in the Slaughter of Animals Act, 1933; Interpretation.
23 & 24 Geo. 5.
c. 39.

“pig” includes any boar, hog or sow;

“slaughterhouse” and “knacker’s yard” have the same meaning respectively in England as in the Slaughter of Animals Act, 1933, and in Scotland as in the Public Health (Scotland) Act, 1897. 60 & 61 Vict.
c. 38.

(2) In Scotland for the purposes of the Slaughter of Animals (Scotland) Acts, 1928 to 1953, the expression “mechanically-operated instrument” includes an instrument for stunning by means of electricity.

4.—(1) This Act may be cited as the Slaughter of Animals (Pigs) Act, 1953. Citation,
extent and
commence-
ment.

(2) This Act shall not apply to Northern Ireland.

(3) The Slaughter of Animals (Scotland) Acts, 1928 and 1949, and this Act as it applies to Scotland may be cited together as the Slaughter of Animals (Scotland) Acts, 1928 to 1953.

(4) This Act shall come into operation on the first day of July, nineteen hundred and fifty-four.

